SMART LEDGER

A simple, offline-first business companion for Rwanda’s small retailers

TRACK STOCK. RECORD SALES.
FOLLOW UP DEBTS. UNDERSTAND YOUR BUSINESS.

INVESTOR PROJECT BRIEF

Product concept • Market problem • Business model • Roadmap

Working concept name. Brand identity, pricing, market size and financial projections should be validated with pilot users before external fundraising.

1. Executive Summary

Smart Ledger is a proposed mobile-first business management tool for small shops, kiosks, bars and market traders in Rwanda. It connects everyday operations—stock intake, sales, customer credit and business reporting—in one simple interface designed around the way small businesses work.

ONE WORKSPACE	OFFLINE-FIRST	ACTIONABLE INSIGHT
Products, sales, payments and debtors connected in one workflow.	Record transactions locally and synchronize when connectivity returns.	Daily, weekly and monthly summaries of sales, stock movement and estimated profit.

The opportunity

Many micro-businesses manage sales, inventory and customer credit through paper notebooks, memory or disconnected tools. Smart Ledger is designed to reduce manual tracking, make outstanding balances visible and help owners understand business performance without requiring complex accounting knowledge.

Stage: concept and product planning. This brief does not claim validated traction, customers, revenue or market-share data.

2. The Problem

Small retailers handle several connected tasks every day, often with limited time and simple devices.

Paper-based credit records	Balances may be missed, disputed or forgotten.	Customer ledger, payment history and reminder workflow.
Limited stock visibility	Owners may discover shortages late or struggle to reconcile quantities.	Stock-in records, sale-linked stock deduction and low-stock alerts.
Unclear daily performance	Cash received, credit sales, costs and personal withdrawals can be confused.	Sales summaries, payment tracking and expense/withdrawal records.

Design principle

Make routine actions fast and understandable: register stock, record a sale, record a payment and see what remains. The product should support Kinyarwanda-first UX, clear currency display and large touch targets.

3. Product Experience

The home screen presents three primary destinations, with a promotional slideshow that may later support relevant supplier offers.

HOME	STOCK	DEBTORS	REPORTS
Business snapshot, ad carousel and sync status.	Products, categories, stock-in, stock-out and low-stock visibility.	Search customers, view paid and remaining amounts, record repayments and send reminders.	Daily, weekly, monthly or custom range; sales, category quantities, estimated profit/loss and trends.

Core sales workflow

1. Select items	2. Choose payment	3. Update records	4. Refresh insights
Choose products and quantities; calculate totals.	Cash, partial payment or credit.	Deduct stock, record payment and calculate outstanding balance.	Update sales, category and debtor reports.

Accounting note: sales revenue, cash collected, outstanding credit, cost of goods sold and operating expenses must be tracked separately. A credit sale is not the same as cash collected; estimated profit requires reliable purchase-cost and expense data.

4. Technology & Offline Reliability

The proposed architecture prioritizes uninterrupted shop-floor use. The phone records transactions locally first, then synchronizes pending changes with the cloud when a connection is available.

Kinyarwanda-first interface • dashboard • stock • sales • debtors • reports
SQLite using Drift (proposed) • offline reads/writes • pending-sync queue
Authenticated REST API • retry and idempotency • conflict handling • audit trail
PostgreSQL • backups • optional SMS gateway • analytics and ad management

Reliability requirements

- Keep locally saved transactions when offline.
- Use unique transaction IDs and safe retries to prevent duplicate sales during synchronization.
- Restrict access by business and role; protect customer phone numbers and financial records.
- Back up cloud data and show clear sync status.
- Record whether reminders are queued, sent or failed.

5. Business Model

A low-friction freemium approach can help users adopt the basic workflow before paying for time-saving features. Pricing below is a hypothesis to test, not a confirmed price.

Free / Starter	Basic products, stock movements, sales and debtor balances.	Which features drive repeat daily use?
Plus subscription	SMS reminders, richer reports, export/print and cloud backup options.	Will owners pay around 2,000 RWF/month, and for what?
Supplier promotions	Clearly labelled promotional placements or offers from wholesalers and brands.	Can promotions create value without distracting from shop tasks?

Potential expansion paths

Supplier ordering, mobile-money reconciliation, multi-branch support, advanced exports and business-owner insights can be considered after core usage and willingness to pay are validated.

6. Market Opportunity & Validation Plan

Smart Ledger addresses a practical workflow problem, but market size, willingness to pay and adoption rates should be established through direct research rather than unsupported headline estimates.

First validation sprint

1	Interview 15–25 shop owners across different business types and locations.
2	Observe how they currently record stock, credit sales, repayments and daily totals.
3	Test a clickable prototype in Kinyarwanda; measure task completion and confusion points.
4	Pilot with 5–10 businesses for 4–6 weeks, with consent and a clear data-handling policy.
5	Test pricing, SMS usefulness, offline reliability and retention before scaling.

Pilot metrics to track

- Weekly active businesses
- Sales and stock movements recorded per business
- Credit balances with complete payment history
- Sync failures, duplicate transactions and data-loss incidents
- Time needed to record a sale
- Trial-to-paid conversion and churn, once paid testing begins

7. Product Roadmap

1. Foundation	Flutter shell, navigation, local database, Kinyarwanda-ready UI and product/category management.	Product records persist offline and after restart.
2. Transactions	Stock-in, sales basket, payment types, stock deduction, customer records and debt balances.	Tested calculations and inventory integrity.
3. Reporting	Date filters, daily/weekly/monthly summaries, category quantities, costs and profit estimates.	Reports reconcile to transaction records.
4. Cloud + messaging	API, sync queue, conflict handling, backups and SMS integration.	Verified sync and SMS status under real network conditions.
5. Pilot + scale	User testing, bug fixes, onboarding, subscription test and supplier-promotion experiment.	Evidence of repeat use and validated commercial assumptions.

This is an indicative implementation sequence. Calendar dates and budget should be set after scope, team capacity and vendor choices are confirmed.

8. Partnership & Investment Opportunity

Smart Ledger is seeking conversations with potential early-stage partners, pilot businesses, mentors and investors who can help validate the product and prepare it for a controlled launch.

Potential use of early funding

PRODUCT ENGINEERING	Flutter app, local database, sync architecture, backend and quality assurance.
FIELD RESEARCH & PILOT	Shop-owner interviews, usability tests, onboarding and support.
CLOUD & COMMUNICATIONS	Hosting, monitoring, backups and SMS-provider integration.
GO-TO-MARKET EXPERIMENTS	Demonstrations, local-language materials, referrals and small-business partnerships.

The next milestone

Build and test a focused pilot that proves shop owners can record stock and sales quickly, maintain accurate outstanding balances and trust the app to retain data offline. Use evidence from the pilot to set pricing, estimate unit economics and define a credible fundraising target.

SMART LEDGER — Make everyday business records easier to manage.

Add founder contact details and confirmed team information before sharing externally.

Disclaimer: This is a concept-stage proposal for discussion. It is not an offer to sell securities, a financial forecast or a guarantee of market demand or business performance.